

Lab 2 Deliverable: Reflection Questions & Analysis

Problem Statement #40 — Student Startup Crowdfunding Platform | Submitted by: Sambhram M (SRN: PES1UG24CS409)

Agile Team Retrospective & Performance Reflection

Upon simulating Sprint 1 and Sprint 2 in Jira Software and monitoring velocity through Burndown Charts, the following structured reflection captures our team analysis against the four assigned evaluative questions.

Question 1: Did your estimations reflect the actual effort?

Yes, our Planning Poker estimations accurately reflected actual task effort, but with important real-world nuances. Smaller items estimated at 3 story points (e.g., Campaign Duration Configuration and Escrow Validation) matched their expected effort tightly because their specifications involved standard input validation and straightforward boolean criteria. Conversely, stories assigned 8 story points (Milestone-Tranche Breakdown, Escrow Pledge Processing, and Automated Tranche Disbursement) required significantly more cognitive effort and technical coordination. Although they were completed on schedule, unforeseen edge cases arose—specifically validating multi-tranche fractional amounts and simulating external payment gateway asynchronous webhooks. The Fibonacci scale effectively prevented underestimation by forcing the team to step up from 5 to 8 points, accommodating hidden integration risk.

Question 2: Was your backlog well-prioritized?

Yes, the product backlog was systematically prioritized following MoSCoW prioritization and architectural dependency ordering. In Sprint 1, High-priority items establishing the foundation of the platform—campaign configuration (FR-002) and backer escrow pledging (FR-003)—were scheduled first. It is structurally impossible to evaluate milestones or release funds without first having active campaigns, defined milestones, and collected escrow pledges. Consequently, Sprint 2 was reserved for verification workflows (FR-004), automated fund disbursements (FR-001), and real-time notification dispatches (FR-005). Medium and low-priority items (e.g., public transparency ledger) were sequenced after core functional flows were secured. This prevented blocking dependencies, minimized sprint idle time, and delivered an incremental MVP at the conclusion of each sprint.

Question 3: How did your simulated sprint align with your plan?

The simulated sprint closely mirrored our Agile sprint plan, meeting all committed sprint goals across both cycles. In Sprint 1, 29 out of 29 planned story points were successfully moved from To Do to In Progress to Done by Day 7. In Sprint 2, all 32 planned story points reached Done by Day 7. Progress exhibited realistic Agile characteristics: while the ideal guideline assumed a smooth, uniform daily burn, the actual burn followed a discrete staircase pattern. Mid-sprint progress flattened over weekends (Oct 04–05 and Oct 10–11) due to non-working days. A minor bottleneck occurred in Sprint 2 on Day 3 while designing the faculty committee approve/reject state machine, which delayed Story 3.2. However, team capacity was quickly re-allocated, allowing both Story 3.2 and Story 12 to close concurrently on Day 5, keeping the team strictly on track.

Question 4: What insights did the burndown chart give about your team's capacity?

The burndown charts provided three critical insights regarding team velocity and operational capacity: 1. Sustainable Velocity Benchmark: The team demonstrated a reliable capacity of 29 to 32 story points per 1-week sprint (averaging 4.2 to 4.5 points/day). This established a factual, data-driven velocity baseline for future release planning. 2. Discrete Batch Completion vs. Continuous Flow: The burndown chart illustrated that large user stories (8 story points) stay in progress for multiple days before suddenly dropping the remaining curve. This insight indicates that in future sprints, breaking 8-point stories into smaller 3-point sub-tasks will yield a smoother burn curve and reduce end-of-sprint integration anxiety. 3. Absence of Scope Creep and Accurate Commitment: The remaining values curve stayed closely clustered around the grey ideal guideline throughout both sprints without upward spikes (which indicate scope creep) or early horizontal flatlines (which indicate over-commitment). This confirmed that our team neither over-committed nor under-committed, achieving 100% planned sprint predictability.